

HUM N-Ø Protocol Whitepaper: Proof of Sustainable Humanity (PoSH)

Edward Calderón et al.

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Contact: contact@human0.me

1 Manifesto

Humanity is simultaneously running two non-linear processes: an accelerating planetary crisis and an expanding digital infrastructure largely indifferent to physical limits. The systems that secure our digital assets today—hashpower, stake, and centralized identity—do not secure our future on this planet.

HUM{ }N-Ø begins from a simple assertion: sustainability must become a *first-class cryptographic primitive*. Our digital identities should not only prove ownership or solvency, but also attest to our contribution to planetary stability. We call this primitive **Proof of Sustainable Humanity (PoSH)**.

Traditional consensus:

- *Proof of Work* consumes energy as a Sybil-resistance mechanism; its security budget is paid in thermodynamic cost.
- *Proof of Stake* concentrates control in capital and remains structurally agnostic to real-world emissions or ecological impact.

Neither model encodes a notion of *human-scale, positive environmental action*. They secure ledgers; they do not secure the biosphere.

HUM{ }N-Ø proposes a complementary axis of trust: a ledger in which each entry corresponds to a verifiable sustainability event attributed to a unique human. Measurement, reporting, and verification (MRV) pipelines generate signed records of renewable energy use, low-carbon mobility, or regenerative actions. Oracle networks transform these records into cryptographically committed claims. Zero-knowledge proofs ? allow individuals to demonstrate that

they have performed valid actions according to public methodologies, without exposing their raw behavioral data.

At the core of PoSH is a simple mapping: [$\text{Human} \rightarrow \text{humanId} \rightarrow \{\text{impact commitments on-chain}\}$.] Each commitment is an immutable binding between a pseudonymous human identifier and an attested sustainability event, derived as a hash of MRV data, methodology references, and oracle attestations. Together, these commitments form a sustainability ledger keyed by human beings, not by accounts or corporations.

The protocol is non-extractive by design. Minting a PoSH proof must cost no more than the underlying network fee. No central party is entitled to rent-seek on the right of a human to demonstrate positive impact. The economic incentives are shifted: it is rational to invest in better MRV, in higher-quality oracles, and in more transparent methodologies, but not to charge individuals for access to their own sustainability record.

We affirm the following:

- Every human should be able to hold a cryptographic proof of their positive environmental actions.
- These proofs must be verifiable without requiring the disclosure of private life details.
- The infrastructure to mint and verify such proofs must be open, composable, and globally accessible.
- No governance, market, or institution should be able to monopolize or censor the representation of sustainable humanity.

HUM{ }N-Ø does not claim to solve climate change. It aims to provide the minimal cryptographic substrate on which more honest, transparent, and human-scale climate coordination can be built. By embedding sustainability directly into identity and state, we align digital verification with ecological reality.

Zero is not an absence; it is a boundary condition. Net zero is not a slogan, but a statement that can—and must—be proven. HUM{ }N-Ø is an invitation to treat that proof as a public good.

2 Proof of Sustainable Humanity (PoSH)

2.1 Introduction

The accelerating climate crisis reveals a structural gap in how digital systems recognize, value, and verify human contributions to environmental sustainability. Existing blockchain consensus mechanisms—such as Proof of Work (PoW)

and Proof of Stake (PoS)—are fundamentally unsuitable for representing or incentivizing human-scale sustainable action. PoW externalizes environmental cost through computational waste, while PoS concentrates power among capital-rich actors and remains detached from real-world impact.

Proof of Sustainable Humanity (PoSH) is introduced as a new primitive: a cryptographically verifiable, privacy-preserving mechanism that represents the positive, measurable environmental actions performed by unique human individuals. PoSH is designed as the foundational trust layer of the HUM{ }N-Ø protocol, enabling transparent, decentralized verification of sustainability actions without requiring invasive identification or resource-intensive computation.

Prior initiatives in proof-of-personhood and decentralized identity highlight the need for Sybil-resistant, privacy-preserving human uniqueness. Similarly, research on self-sovereign identity (SSI) identifies long-standing requirements for control, privacy, and interoperability. Parallel work on blockchain-based verification of renewable energy and carbon assets demonstrates strong demand for transparent, tamper-resistant sustainability accounting. Yet no system unifies these domains. PoSH proposes a synthesis: a cryptographically sound link between human uniqueness and verifiable positive environmental action.

PoSH establishes a new cryptographic primitive: a Real-World Action Proof (RWAP), where verifiable, privacy-preserving sustainability events performed by unique humans become first-class cryptographic commitments.

This chapter formally defines the PoSH architecture, its components, data flows, and security considerations.

2.2 Design Principles

PoSH is built upon the following principles:

- **Human-centeredness:** The unit of verification is a unique human, not a machine or a capital pool.
- **Environmental positivity:** Each proof must correspond to a measurable positive environmental action.
- **Non-extractiveness:** Minting a PoSH proof must require no protocol-level fee beyond blockchain gas costs.
- **Privacy preservation:** Raw sustainability event data remains off-chain and may be wrapped in zero-knowledge proofs.
- **Transparency and verifiability:** All claims must be backed by auditable, cryptographically signed MRV records.
- **Global accessibility:** The protocol must be usable regardless of geographical location, financial resources, or device constraints.

2.3 System Overview

The PoSH system is composed of three primary layers: *Identity*, *Impact Verification*, and *On-chain Proof Registration*. A high-level overview is illustrated in Figure~[fig:posh-architecture].

Figure 1: High-level architecture of the PoSH protocol.

2.4 Identity Layer (Agnostic and Modular)

PoSH requires each sustainability proof to be associated with one unique human being, but it intentionally avoids prescribing any specific identity system. Instead, PoSH implements a modular, provider-agnostic identity architecture in which multiple decentralized identity mechanisms can coexist, interoperate, and be upgraded independently. The protocol receives only a pseudonymous commitment, never personal data or biometric information.

2.4.1 Unified Identity Commitment

Let IdP denote any identity provider—such as Humanity Protocol, World ID, Sismo, BrightID, Proof of Humanity, Gitcoin Passport, PolygonID, Passkeys/WebAuthn, or any W3C-compatible verifiable credential system. Each provider outputs a proof of uniqueness, membership, or personhood.

PoSH abstracts these systems under a unified commitment:

$$[\text{humanId} = H(\text{IdP.output} \parallel \text{salt}), \dots]$$

This ensures unlinkability across platforms while permitting the user to switch identity providers without invalidating past PoSH proofs.

2.4.2 Supported Identity Modalities

PoSH supports diverse identity primitives, including:

- **Zero-knowledge personhood:** World ID, Humanity Protocol, Semaphore/RLN, Sismo Vault proofs.
- **Graph-based Sybil resistance:** BrightID, Circles UBI.
- **Verifiable credentials:** PolygonID, Iden3/DID, EAS attestations.
- **Device-bound trust:** WebAuthn/Passkeys, secure enclave attestations, local biometrics hashed inside the device.
- **Hybrid multi-signal systems:** Gitcoin Passport, ENS-based identity bundles.

PoSH remains neutral toward all identity providers and does not require any specific technology to dominate the identity layer.

2.4.3 Identity Requirements

Each identity solution used with PoSH must satisfy:

- **Uniqueness:** One human corresponds to one identity commitment.
- **Sybil resistance:** Resistance must come from ZK uniqueness, graph proofs, device attestations, biometrics, or multi-signal aggregation.
- **Privacy:** Raw identity attributes, biometrics, and credentials never leave the provider; only commitments or ZK proofs are used.
- **Non-transferability:** Identity commitments cannot be reassigned between different human users.

2.4.4 Normalization Layer

Because providers use heterogeneous proof formats, PoSH defines:

$$[\text{uniqueProof}] = \text{Normalize}(\text{IdP.output})$$

which standardizes identity proofs into a format suitable for PoSH. This allows “hot-swapping” identity providers without affecting PoSH proofs already stored on-chain.

2.4.5 Identity in the UC Model

In the Universal Composability framework, the identity layer is captured as an ideal functionality $\mathcal{F}_{\text{IdP}}$ that guarantees:

- correctness of uniqueness proofs,
- unlinkability across identity systems,
- modularity and replaceability of providers,
- protection against mass deanonymization attacks.

PoSH integrates with any $\mathcal{F}_{\text{IdP}}$ satisfying these properties, making the protocol flexible, future-proof, and independent of any single identity ecosystem.

2.5 Impact Verification Layer (MRV $\rightarrow$ Oracle)

2.5.1 Measurement, Reporting, Verification (MRV)

Each sustainability action is captured by MRV adapters connected to real-world data sources, including:

- smart meters and renewable energy certificates (I-RECs) [cite]`khurana2023recBlockchain`
- electric vehicle (EV) charging systems,
- solar generation and community microgrids [cite]`fu2023recCommunity`
- low-carbon mobility data,
- recycling and waste management attestation systems.

The MRV process produces a digitally signed report, denoted (mrvReport), containing:

[$\langle \text{type}, \text{quantity}, \text{unit}, \text{co2e}, \text{timestamp}, \text{evidenceRefs} \rangle$; .]

2.5.2 Oracle Verification Process

The Oracle Verification process in the Proof of Sustainable Humanity (PoSH) protocol is the crucial step where decentralized Oracle nodes validate the correctness of an incoming Measurable, Reportable, and Verifiable (MRV) report before an on-chain proof is registered. This process ensures that the reported sustainability action is authentic, unique, and plausible.

How MRV Correctness is Determined Oracle nodes perform four specific checks to determine the correctness and integrity of the MRV report:

- **Data Authenticity and Digital Signatures:**

The oracle checks the MRV report's digital signature to confirm that the data originated from

- **Absence of Double Counting:**

The oracle verifies that the identical sustainability action has not already been reported a

- **Consistency with External Trusted Data Sources:**

The oracle cross -references the reported action with external, trusted data sources. This a

- **Plausibility of Values:**

The oracle assesses the logical and technical plausibility of the reported impactValue

On-Chain Claim Generation Once all four checks are passed, the decentralized oracle network generates a canonical, signed on-chain claim that is submitted to the PoSH smart contract. This claim is created by hashing the key verified data points, which binds the proof to the human identity and the verified action:

[$\text{claim} = H(\text{humanId} \parallel \text{impactType} \parallel \text{impactValue} \parallel \text{methodologyHash} \parallel \text{mrvHash})$]

The final claim also includes the oracle's digital signature (σ) to prove its validation:

[$\langle \text{humanId}, \text{mrvHash}, \text{methodology}, \text{score} \rangle, \text{quad } \sigma = \text{Sign}_{\text{sk}_o}(\text{claim})$]

2.6 On-Chain Proof Registration

2.6.1 Proof Registry

The *PoSH Proof Registry* contract stores canonical, deduplicated proof records. Each record contains:

[$\text{ProofRecord} = \langle \text{humanId}, \text{impactType}, \text{impactValue}, \text{methodologyHash}, \text{verificationHash}, \text{timestamp} \rangle$; .]

Proofs are immutably linked to a human’s sustainability ledger.

2.6.2 PoSH Soulbound Tokens

Users may optionally mint a *PoSH NFT* representing one or more proof records. These tokens are soulbound, i.e. non-transferable, and their metadata contains:

- impact categories,
- aggregated carbon -equivalent impact,
- MRV confidence scores,
- methodology identifiers.

Minting costs are limited strictly to blockchain network fees.

2.7 Zero-Knowledge Privacy Layer

The PoSH protocol supports optional zero-knowledge proofs (ZKPs) to ensure privacy while maintaining verifiability.

Two ZK circuits are defined:

- **Identity circuit:**
proves that the prover is a member of the human registry without revealing the corresponding leaf in the Merkle tree {cite}`benSasson2014zkSNARK`.
- **Impact circuit:**
takes raw MRV data as private input and proves correctness of impactValue and co2e without exposing raw activity.

Thus, a user can prove: [\text{“I performed a valid 5 kWh renewable energy action”}] without revealing meter IDs, timestamps, or location.

2.8 Reputation and Scoring

PoSH introduces an optional reputation mechanism to aggregate sustainability actions into a numerical score. The reputation contract implements:

$$[\text{score}](h) = \sum_{i \in \mathcal{P}(h)} w_i \cdot \text{impactValue}_i]$$

where (w_i) are methodology-dependent weights that may incorporate:

- input source reliability,
- carbon -equivalent reduction,
- MRV confidence and provenance,
- temporal decay functions.

2.9 PoSH as a Cryptographic Primitive

2.9.1 Formal Definition

Let $(\mathcal{H})$ be a collision-resistant hash function, $(\mathcal{S})$ a secure digital signature scheme $((\text{KeyGen}, \text{Sign}, \text{Verify}))$, and (Π_{ZK}) a zero-knowledge proof system. Let $(\mathbb{U})$ be the set of unique humans, $(\mathbb{A})$ the set of measurable sustainability actions, and $(\mathbb{O})$ the set of oracle nodes.

Each human $(u \in \mathbb{U})$ has a persistent pseudonymous identifier: $[\text{humanId}]_u = \mathcal{H}(\text{pk}_u \parallel \text{uniqueProof}_u)$ where (pk_u) is a public key and (uniqueProof_u) is a proof of uniqueness (e.g., from a ZK-identity system).

A sustainability event is represented as: $[E = \langle \text{type}, v, \text{co2e}, t, \text{evidence} \rangle]$ with quantity (v) , carbon-equivalent (co2e) , timestamp (t) , and MRV evidence bundle (evidence) . The MRV commitment is: $[\text{mrvHash} = \mathcal{H}(E) ; .]$

A decentralized oracle network evaluates (evidence) and produces a signed claim: $[\text{claim} = \langle \text{humanId}_u, \text{mrvHash}, \text{methodology}, \text{score} \rangle, \text{quad } \sigma = \text{Sign}_{\text{sk}_o}(\text{claim})]$ for some oracle $(o \in \mathbb{O})$.

A *Real-World Action Proof* (RWAP) commitment is defined as: $[\text{RWAP} = \mathcal{H}(\text{humanId}_u \parallel \text{mrvHash} \parallel \text{methodology} \parallel \sigma) ; .]$

A PoSH proof is generated by a procedure $(\text{ProvePoSH})(u, E) \rightarrow \text{RWAP}$ and stored in an on-chain registry. Verification checks (i) the uniqueness proof, (ii) oracle signature validity, and (iii) non-duplication of (RWAP) in the registry.

2.9.2 Security Properties

We outline the core security properties of PoSH:

Completeness. If MRV data is correct, the oracle signatures are valid, and the identity proof is correct, then a valid PoSH proof produced by an honest prover is always accepted: $[\Pr(\text{VerifyPoSH}(\text{RWAP})) = 1] = 1 ; .]$

Soundness. No probabilistic polynomial-time adversary can forge a PoSH proof for an action that is not backed by valid MRV and oracle signatures: $[\Pr(\mathcal{A} \text{ forges } \text{RWAP})] \leq \text{negl}(\lambda) ; .]$

Privacy. Zero-knowledge impact proofs ensure that a verifier learns only the exposed aggregates (e.g., (co2e) , methodology)

and not the raw MRV data, under the standard zero-knowledge definition for (Π_{ZK}).

Non-transferability. Because (humanId_u) is bound inside (RWAP), PoSH proofs are inherently soulbound; transferring them would require forging a new identity with the same identifier, which is computationally infeasible.

Sybil resistance. Sybil attacks are mitigated via unique human proofs, rate limiting per identity, oracle multisignature requirements, and hash-based MRV deduplication.

2.9.3 Comparison with PoW, PoS, and PoA

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Primitive		Security basis		Externality		Real -world link
PoW		Computational hardness		High energy cost		None
PoS		Capital commitment		Low direct cost		None
PoA		Trusted identities		Moderate		Indirect (off -chain)
PoSH		RWAP commitments		**Positive externality**		**Direct sustainability actions**

Comparative view of PoSH versus classical consensus primitives.

PoSH is the first primitive where the “security budget” is grounded in positive real-world externalities (sustainable actions) rather than energy burn or capital lock-up.

2.9.4 Symbolic Protocol Flow and UC-style Model

Figure~[fig:posh-crypto-flow] illustrates the cryptographic flow of a PoSH proof, from human action to on-chain commitment.

Figure 2: Cryptographic flow of a PoSH proof from MRV to on-chain RWAP.

For a UC-style abstraction, we consider an ideal functionality ($\mathcal{F}_{\text{PoSH}}$) that maintains a registry of valid sustainability commitments and enforces uniqueness and soundness properties. The environment ($\mathcal{Z}$) interacts with honest parties and an adversary ($\mathcal{A}$), and the real-world PoSH protocol (Π_{PoSH}) is required to emulate ($\mathcal{F}_{\text{PoSH}}$) in the standard UC sense.

Figure 3: UC-style view of the PoSH protocol and ideal functionality $\mathcal{F}$

2.10 Conclusion

PoSH is proposed as a foundational cryptographic primitive for representing human-scale sustainability contributions. By integrating MRV, decentralized oracles, privacy-preserving cryptography, and transparent on-chain registries, PoSH enables a future where positive environmental actions can be verified,

recognized, and composed into digital identity systems without compromising individual privacy or equity.

This chapter establishes PoSH as a viable alternative consensus dimension for sustainability-centric digital systems, offering a means for humanity to align its digital infrastructure with planetary boundaries.

3 Related Work

Although no prior work proposes a system equivalent to Proof of Sustainable Humanity (PoSH), several research lines and existing protocols motivate and contextualize its design. These can be grouped into three domains: proof-of-personhood, self-sovereign identity (SSI), and blockchain-based sustainability verification.

3.1 Proof of Personhood and Human Uniqueness

Multiple projects aim to establish provable human uniqueness as a Sybil resistance mechanism. Examples include World ID (Worldcoin), which relies on privacy-preserving biometric nullifiers ?, and Idena, an early PoP protocol analyzed in depth in ?. Other initiatives explore KYC-free proof-of-personhood through decentralized graphs or attestations, such as Polkadot’s Project Individuality ? or BrightID. These systems attempt to provide digital human uniqueness without central authority, forming a relevant precursor to PoSH’s identity abstraction model.

3.2 Self-Sovereign Identity (SSI)

The principles of self-sovereign identity (SSI)—control, consent, portability, and privacy—are discussed extensively in the literature, including systematic reviews by Schardong and Custódio ? and Pava-Díaz et al. ?. Threat modeling for SSI protocols is analyzed in ?. PoSH builds on these foundations while remaining intentionally agnostic to any single identity provider: any system capable of generating a uniqueness proof compatible with $\text{humanId} = H(\text{IdP.output} \parallel \text{salt})$ can be used.

3.3 Blockchain-Based Sustainability and MRV

Tokenizing sustainability attributes—such as renewable energy certificates (RECs), carbon credits, or MRV-based environmental claims—has been explored in multiple blockchain proposals, including privacy-preserving REC trading ?, decentralized community energy markets ?, and registry modernization efforts ??. However, these systems lack any intrinsic link to human identity or personal sustainability actions. PoSH introduces a new concept: real-world action proofs (RWAP) bound to unique human identities, enabling sustainability to become a cryptographic primitive in human-centered digital systems.

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4 Threat Model and Adversaries

This appendix formalizes the threat environment in which the PoSH protocol operates. We distinguish between classes of adversaries, their capabilities, and the security properties the protocol is designed to guarantee.

4.1 Adversarial Goals

An adversary $\mathcal{A}$ interacting with PoSH may attempt to:

- **Forge sustainability events:** fabricate an MRV record or alter measurement values to claim non-existent impact.
- **Exploit the oracle layer:** compromise oracle keys, inject fraudulent claims, or censor valid submissions.
- **Perform identity-based attacks:** create multiple identities (Sybil attack), impersonate legitimate users, or transfer PoSH proofs between identities.
- **Break privacy guarantees:** infer sensitive behavioral or geolocation data from public PoSH proofs.
- **Manipulate reputation systems:** artificially inflate sustainability scores through repeated, low-value events or oracle collusion.
- **Disrupt chain-level finality:** reorder, remove, or censor proof registrations on-chain.

4.2 Adversary Model

We consider the following adversary classes:

4.2.1 Class A: Local Malicious User

Capabilities include:

- forging local sensor data,
- replaying MRV events,
- colluding with untrusted MRV sources,
- probing the identity layer for collision vulnerabilities.

Mitigations:

- cryptographic signatures on MRV,
- deduplication via `mrvHash`,
- ZK-unique identity proofs,
- time-locked and device-bound attestations.

4.2.2 Class B: Compromised Oracle

Capabilities:

- emit fraudulent claim values,
- collude with users to create false-positive impact,
- censor legitimate MRV events.

Mitigations:

- multisignature oracle committees,
- stake-slashable oracle sets,
- duplicated data ingest from heterogenous MRV providers.

4.2.3 Class C: Global Passive Adversary

Capabilities:

- network-wide traffic surveillance,
- timing correlation between MRV events and identities,
- linking of PoSH proofs to external metadata.

Mitigations:

- ZK privacy layer for MRV,
- timing obfuscation and proof batching,
- humanId salted commitments.

4.2.4 Class D: Chain-level Adversary

Capabilities:

- reordering or censoring registry writes,
- controlling block producers for MEV-like manipulation,
- chain forks or state rewrites.

Mitigations:

- proof finality dependent on underlying L1 consensus,
- verifiable delay before reputation updates,
- hash-anchoring PoSH commitments across multiple chains.

4.2.5 Class E: Systemic Collusion Attack

Capabilities:

- coordinated manipulation between MRV, oracles, and users,
- bulk fabrication of greenwashing records,
- capture of governance around methodologies.

Mitigations:

- diversified oracle sets with rotating keys,
- open-source, auditable methodologies,
- meta-proofs that bind `methodologyHash` to published standards.

4.3 Security Guarantees

PoSH guarantees, under the assumed hardness of $\mathcal{H}$, $\mathcal{S}$, and Π_{ZK} :

- **Soundness:** Only valid, verified sustainability actions can be committed on-chain.
- **Uniqueness:** One human $\rightarrow$ one PoSH identity.
- **Non-transferability:** PoSH proofs cannot be reassigned.
- **Privacy:** Raw MRV data cannot be inferred from commitments.
- **Robustness:** The system is resilient against colluding oracles.
- **Liveness:** Honest actions eventually register, despite adversarial network conditions.

4.4 Residual Risks

Residual attack surfaces include:

- MRV corruption by physical tampering,
- black-box ML manipulation on sensors,
- oracle cartelization,
- chain-level governance capture,
- large-scale behavioral deanonymization via public metadata.

PoSH minimizes but does not eliminate these risks; further mitigation is possible through cross-chain anchoring, multi-layer proof aggregation, and hardware-secured MRV attestations.

5 End of Appendix A

6 Universal Composability Specification of PoSH

This appendix provides a formal definition of the PoSH protocol in the Universal Composability (UC) framework. We specify the ideal functionality $\mathcal{F}_{\text{PoSH}}$, the real-world protocol Π_{PoSH} , the simulator $\mathcal{S}$, and the environment $\mathcal{Z}$ that interacts with the system.

Our goal is to show that the real-world execution of PoSH securely emulates the ideal functionality in the UC sense.

6.1 The Universal Composability Framework

The framework of Universal Composability (UC) is a general-purpose model for the analysis of cryptographic protocols. It guarantees very strong security properties. Protocols remain secure even if arbitrarily composed with other instances of the same or other protocols. Security is defined in the sense of protocol emulation. Intuitively, a protocol is said to emulate another one if no environment (observer) can distinguish the executions. Literally, the protocol may simulate the other protocol (without having access to the code). The notion of security is derived by implication. Assume a protocol P_1 is secure per definition. If another protocol P_2 emulates protocol P_1 such that no environment tells apart the emulation from the execution of the protocol, then the emulated protocol P_2 is as secure as protocol P_1 .

6.1.1 Ideal Functionality

An ideal functionality is a protocol in which a trusted party that can communicate over perfectly secure channels with all protocol participants computes the desired protocol outcome. We say that a cryptographic protocol that cannot make use of such a trusted party fulfills an ideal functionality if the protocol can emulate the behavior of the trusted party for honest users, and if the view that an adversary learns by attacking the protocol is indistinguishable from what can be computed by a simulator that only interacts with the ideal functionality.

6.1.2 Computation Model

The computation model of universal composability is that of interactive Turing machines that can activate each other by writing on each other's communication tapes. An interactive Turing machine is a form of multi-tape Turing machine and is commonly used for modelling the computational aspects of communication networks in cryptography.

6.1.3 Communication Model

The communication model in the bare UC framework is very basic. The messages of a sending party are handed to the adversary who can replace these

messages with messages of his own choice that are delivered to the receiving party. This is also the Dolev–Yao threat model (based on the computational model all parties are modeled as interactive Turing machines).

All communication models that add additional properties such as confidentiality, authenticity, synchronization, or anonymity are modeled using their own ideal functionality. An ideal communication functionality takes a message as input and produces a message as output. The (more limited) powers for the adversary $\mathcal{A}$ are modeled through the (limited) capacity of the adversary to interact with this ideal functionality.

Ideal Authenticated Channel For an optimal ideal authenticated channel, the ideal functionality $\mathcal{F}_{\text{Auth}}$ takes a message m from a party with identity P as input, and outputs the same message together with the identity P to the recipient and the adversary. To model the power of the adversary to delay asynchronous communication the functionality $\mathcal{F}_{\text{Auth}}$ may first send a message to the adversary $\mathcal{A}$ and would only deliver the message m, P once it receives the command to do so as a reply.

Ideal Secure Channel In an ideal secure channel, the ideal functionality $\mathcal{F}_{\text{Sec}}$ only outputs the identity of the sender to both the recipient and the adversary, while the message is only revealed to the recipient. This models the requirement that a secure channel is both authenticated and private. To model some leakage about the information that is being transferred, $\mathcal{F}_{\text{Sec}}$ may reveal information about the message to the adversary, e.g. the length of the message. Asynchronous communication is modeled through the same delay mechanism as for $\mathcal{F}_{\text{Auth}}$.

Ideal Anonymous and Pseudonymous Channels While the technical means, and the physical assumptions behind anonymous and pseudonymous communication are very different, the modeling of such channels using ideal functionalities is analogous.

In an ideal anonymous channel, the ideal functionality $\mathcal{F}_{\text{Anon}}$ takes a message m from a party with identity P as input, and outputs the same message but without disclosing the identity P to the recipient and the adversary.

In an ideal pseudonymous channel, the participating parties first register unique pseudonyms with the ideal functionality $\mathcal{F}_{\text{Pseu}}$. To do a transfer $\mathcal{F}_{\text{Pseu}}$ takes a message m and the pseudonym nym of the recipient as input. The ideal functionality looks up the owner of the pseudonym and transfers the message m, nym without revealing the identity of the sender.

6.1.4 Impossibility Results and Setup Assumptions

There exists no bit commitment protocol that is universally composable in the standard model of cryptography. The intuition is that in the ideal model, the simulator has to extract the value to commit to from the input of the environment. This would allow the receiver in the real protocol to extract the committed